

ENG101

LESSON 24

I. Dependent Word Fragments

Some fragments contain a subject and a verb, but they do not express a complete thought e.g

- Since Ami was tired.
- When the postman arrived.
- After I had switched off the light.
- Since Ami was tired, she took a nap.- When the postman arrived, we handed him the letters.- There was loud knocking on the front door after I had switched off the light.

Practice 1. Identify the part you think is not a complete sentence.

1. *After the new department store opened. Several small shops went out of business.*
 2. *The nurse pierced my arm four times with a syringe. Trying to take a blood sample.*
 3. *The old lady was trembling with excitement. As it was her first airplane ride.*
 4. *The police cordoned off the area. Because there was a gas leak.*
 5. *The small child was always active. Running, jumping, climbing on chairs, dashing in and out of rooms.*
- *Sarah had to clean up the mess that the children left in the verandah.*
 - *I passed the chemistry which I had expected to fail.*
 - *Yesterday I ran to a man who was my best friend in school.*
 - *Sarah had to clean up the mess that the children left in the verandah.*
 - *I passed the chemistry which I had expected to fail.*
 - *Yesterday I ran into a man who was my best friend in school.*

Practice 2:

This practice will give you a sense of the difference between a dependent-word fragment and a complete sentence. Turn each fragment into a sentence by adding a statement that completes the thought.

1. *When I rang the doorbell, _____.*
2. *Since I had forgotten my house keys, _____.*
3. *As I walked into the classroom, _____.*
4. *Unless her temperature goes down soon, _____.*
5. *Schools were closed yesterday, _____.*

(a)- Hoping to buy things cheaply. Poor people often go the Sunday bazaars.

(b)- The ladies jogged through the park. To lose weight.

- Hoping to buy things cheaply, poor people often go to the Sunday bazaar.-Poor people often go to the Sunday bazaar. They hope to buy things cheaply.

- The ladies jogged through the park. They wanted to lose weight.

Practice 3:

First identify the -ing or to fragment in each of the following items. Then rewrite the correct version using one of the two methods just discussed.

- 1- *Police officers stood all over the road. Directing traffic around the accident.*
2. *Rising high into the sky. The huge yellow kite could be seen for miles.*
3. *Sarah painted a landscape. To enter the contest*
4. *To get off the diving board. The swimmer did a somersault.*

III. Added-Detail Fragment- *Everyone enjoyed the feast. Except the fish.*

- We had to read several novels. Including 'The Ice Age'.

Practice 4

Identify the added - detail fragment in each of the following items then write the correct version using one of the two methods given earlier.

1. *The former playmates walked passed one another. Without saying a word.*
2. *For a main dish, I often serve meat and vegetables. For example, fish and spinach.*
3. *The policeman searched the room for clues. Such as old photographs, old letters and old receipts.*
4. *Oranges are full of nutrients. Especially vitamin C.*

IV. Missing - Subject Fragments

-The poor woman paid all her utility bills. But then had little money left over for food.

- The nurse held a smiling baby. Then posed for the photographers.

(a) - The poor woman paid all her utility bills but had little money left for her food..

*-The nurse held a smiling **baby and then** posed for the photographers.*

OR(b) - The poor woman paid all her utility **bills. But she had little money left for her food..**

*- The nurse held a smiling baby. Then **she** posed for the photographers.*

Practice 5:

Identify the missing subject-fragment in each of the following items. Then write the correct version using one of the two methods you have learned.

1. The sleeping dog opened one eye to look at the postman. And then went back to sleep.

2. Each morning, my secretary checks the answering machine for messages. Then opens the mail.

3. Maryam skipped her afternoon classes. And worked on a paper due the next morning.

4. The movie had melodious music and popular actors. Yet made little money at the box office.

Lesson Review

Answer each question by filling in the correct word/words in the blank space.

1. To be sentence, a group of words must contain a subject and a _____ and it must express _____.
2. Words such as *because*, *until* and *while* are known as _____ words because word groups that begin with them depend on another statement to complete the thought.
3. Fragments that begin with words such as *like*, *especially*, and *for example* are known as _____ fragments.
4. One way to correct an added-detail fragment is to create a new _____ by adding a subject and _____ to the fragment.
5. One way to correct a missing-subject fragment is to add a _____ to the fragment.

Test

Sentence Fragments

Rewrite the following. Correct any fragments.

1. *We go to Murree Hills during the summer vacations. Whenever we can, of course.*
2. *Our literary circle has only two officers. Miss Niazi being president and Mr. Awan being secretary treasure.*
3. *Living in the city is not always pleasant. During the summer months particularly.*
4. *He hated learning foreign languages. Latin, French and German especially.*
5. *Moving up the mountain at a fast pace. The soldiers were soon exhausted. They were not used to climbing at high altitudes. Where the air was thinner.*
6. *When people are scared. The hair on their bodies really can "stand on end". Each hair is attached to a tiny muscle. Which can pull the hair straight up. The muscles react together in response to a great fright.*

The word groups beginning with when & which are dependent – word fragment, so each needs to be added to the sentence that comes before or after it. When people are scared, the hair on their bodies really can “stand on end”. Each hair is attached to a tiny muscle which can pull the hair straight up. The muscles react together in response to a great fright.

